

جامعة نيويورك أبوظبي  NYU ABU DHABI	STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE FOR Lithium Battery Management		CTP_Kin_021	
			PO#:	Issue: 01
			Author: Samuel Prieto	
			Date prepared: 06/30/2026	
			Approved by: Oraib Al-Ketan	
			Date approved: 06/30/2026	
			Location: [RL2, GF, ERB]	

SCOPE OF DOCUMENT:

This document describes the standard of operation of the Lithium Battery Management.

1. EMERGENCY SHUTDOWN PROCEDURE

The system does not have an emergency shutdown procedure. In case of emergency, unplug the system from the electrical connection.

2. EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Responsible Person: Samuel Prieto - samuel.prieto@nyu.edu - 02-628-7735

Director of Laboratory: Osama Abdullah - oa22@nyu.edu - 02-628-4990

Facilities Management: Jake Edmondson - je53@nyu.edu - 02-628-4756 / 056-194-5026

Laboratory Operations: Tariq Abu Issa - tia1@nyu.edu - 050-5636228

Public Safety: Security Helpdesk - 02-628-7777

EHS: Ammar Al Mahmoud - aoa3@nyu.edu - 050-6168414

Emergency Services: Police/Fire/Ambulance - 999

3. THIS STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP) IS FOR A:

- ☐ Specific laboratory procedure or experiment [Examples: Operation of particular lab instrument]
- ☒ Generic laboratory procedure [Examples: distillation, chromatography, etc.]
- ☐ Specific chemical or class of chemicals with similar hazards [Examples: organic azides, etc.]

4. PROCESS OR EXPERIMENT DESCRIPTION

This SOP establishes minimum requirements for safe management of rechargeable LiPo and Li-ion batteries in the Kinesis shared charging and storage area, including storage, handling, inspection, charging, quarantine, emergency response, and disposal coordination.

- Applies to rechargeable LiPo and Li-ion packs handled in the Kinesis lab shared charging/storage area.
- Defines only three compliant battery states: approved storage, active use, or active charging under supervision.
- Prohibits storing or leaving idle batteries at the charging station.
- Requires pre-charge inspection, correct charger/profile selection, and supervised charging.
- Specifies approved storage locations for small packs, large high-energy packs, OEM robot batteries, and suspect batteries.
- Requires monthly Battery Manager inspections and record retention.
- Provides quarantine and emergency-response rules for swollen, damaged, abnormal, or end-of-life batteries.

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Frequency: As required

Duration: As required

5. SAFETY LITERATURE REVIEW & HAZARD SUMMARY

Hazardous Substances

Rechargeable lithium batteries may release toxic/corrosive gases, smoke, and hazardous residues during venting, fire, or thermal runaway.

Other Hazards

- Fire and explosion
- Thermal runaway and re-ignition
- Electrical short circuit from exposed terminals or connectors
- Burn injury from hot, smoking, venting, or burning batteries
- Projectile fragments or cell rupture during battery incidents
- Aggregate storage risk from many high-energy packs
- Over-charge, over-discharge, incorrect chemistry/profile, and high-current charging hazards

Safety Guidelines

- Follow manufacturer instructions, institutional policy, and EHS direction when stricter than this SOP.
- Use only approved chargers and correct chemistry, cell count, voltage limit, current limit, and balance mode.
- Do not charge overnight or unattended; remain in or near the lab for the entire charge session.
- Do not charge swollen, damaged, leaking, hot, smoking, venting, unknown, or suspect batteries.
- Protect terminals from short circuiting and keep batteries away from conductive objects and flammables.
- Do not store batteries on the charging table; return them promptly to approved storage after charging.
- Do not open a BAT-SAFE/BatBox or yellow cabinet during a battery incident; keep it closed and evacuate.

References

- Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA). Lithium-ion Battery Safety, Fact Sheet FS-4480, January 2025.
- Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA). Preventing Fire and/or Explosion Injury from Small and Wearable Lithium Battery Powered Devices, SHIB 06-20-2019.
- UBC Safety & Risk Services. Guideline for Lithium Battery Safety in Research Applications, CHEM-GDL-005, May 2025.

Risk Assessment (RA)

RA performed and documented ☐ Yes ☐ No

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Location of RA:

6. STORAGE REQUIREMENTS

- Only three battery states are allowed: approved storage, active use, or active charging under supervision.
- Small 4S/6S LiPo packs shall be stored in the assigned BAT-SAFE/BatBox with lids latched and vents unobstructed.
- Large high-energy packs, including large no-BMS soft packs and smart UAV packs, shall be stored in the yellow fire-resistant cabinet.
- OEM robot batteries shall be stored in the yellow fire-resistant cabinet, OEM case, or other OEM/EHS-approved storage.
- Damaged or suspect batteries are not normal storage items and shall follow quarantine procedures.
- Do not store batteries on the charging table, regular benches, desks, floors, robots, drawers, carts, backpacks, or ordinary cabinets.
- Do not store a battery connected to a charger, robot, test fixture, power supply, or loose extension lead.
- Keep cabinet doors closed and BAT-SAFE/BatBox lids latched except while placing or removing batteries.
- Do not exceed manufacturer rating or EHS-approved capacity of any storage container or cabinet.
- Store only compatible batteries and battery accessories in the battery storage area; do not store unrelated combustibles with batteries.
- Terminal protection is required whenever batteries are not connected for active use or charging.
- For standard LiPo/Li-ion multi-cell packs without BMS, use storage mode and target approximately 3.75-3.85 V per cell unless manufacturer instructions specify otherwise.
- For packs not expected to be used for more than 3 days, return to storage voltage/SOC unless manufacturer instructions specify otherwise.
- Follow OEM storage/SOC instructions for smart/BMS/OEM packs.

7. STEP-BY-STEP OPERATING PROCEDURE

PPE Required.

☒ appropriate street clothing (long pants, closed-toed shoes)

☐ gloves

☐ safety goggles ☒ safety glasses ☐ face shield

☐ lab coat ☐ flame-resistant lab coat ☒ other: Closed-toe shoes, long pants, and hair/clothing secured away from leads/fans/chargers. Avoid conductive jewelry. For damaged/suspect battery handling, use heat-resistant or cut-resistant gloves if available; face shield may be used if available.

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This procedure governs routine handling, charging, storage, inspection, and abnormal-battery response for rechargeable LiPo and Li-ion batteries in the Kinesis shared charging/storage area. Stricter manufacturer instructions, institutional policy, or EHS direction take priority.

Scope and Applicability

This SOP applies to all users who store, handle, inspect, charge, discharge, transport within the lab, use, quarantine, or arrange disposal of rechargeable lithium batteries in the Kinesis lab space.

Included batteries are rechargeable LiPo and Li-ion packs, including hobby/RC-style packs with exposed discharge and balance leads, large UAV packs, smart/BMS-style packs, and OEM robot batteries.

Excluded batteries are primary lithium-metal cells and batteries, facility-scale energy storage systems, and battery manufacturing or testing activities beyond normal charging and use. These require separate EHS review and procedures.

Other chemistries such as lead-acid, NiCd, NiMH, and LiFePO₄ must be charged and stored only with chemistry-specific equipment and manufacturer/EHS instructions. Do not use a LiPo/Li-ion charging profile for other chemistries.

Roles and Responsibilities

All users must complete required training, inspect batteries before use or charge, use only approved chargers and settings, supervise charging, keep the charging table clear, return batteries to approved storage, and report abnormal batteries and incidents immediately.

Each participating lab shall designate a Battery Manager for its batteries. The Battery Manager maintains ownership records, performs monthly inspections, checks storage voltage/SOC, corrects storage violations, labels and quarantines suspect batteries, and coordinates disposal.

The Battery Manager Coordinator or Lab Manager maintains the master inventory, approved storage layout, inspection records, training records, emergency supplies, signage, and SOP revision process.

The PI or Director of Laboratory approves the SOP and any exceptions for unusual batteries, custom charging setups, parallel charging, modified packs, or high-energy test configurations.

Permitted Battery Locations

The charging station is not a storage area. Batteries may be on the charging table only while actively connected to a charger and being supervised, or while being prepared for immediate use.

At the end of a charge session, the battery must be disconnected and moved to approved storage or installed in equipment for immediate use.

Any battery state other than approved storage, active use, or active charging under supervision is non-compliant.

1. Keep batteries in approved storage when disconnected and not in immediate use.
2. Use batteries only when installed in or connected to equipment for active work under supervision.
3. Charge batteries only on the metal charging table using an approved charger under supervision.
4. Disconnect promptly after charging and move the battery to approved storage or immediate use.

Approved storage	Battery is disconnected, terminals protected, labeled, and placed in its assigned BAT-SAFE/BatBox or yellow cabinet location.
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Active use	Battery is installed in or connected to equipment for active work under supervision.
Active charging	Battery is connected to an approved charger on the metal charging table under supervision.

Labeling, Handling, and Internal Transport

Every battery pack shall have a readable label or attached tag with battery ID or asset number, owning lab and responsible Battery Manager, chemistry, cell count, nominal voltage, capacity, any special charge mode such as LiHV, normal storage location, and where practical the date added to inventory and date of last storage-voltage check.

Unknown, unlabeled, or ownerless batteries shall not be charged and shall be treated as suspect until identified by the Battery Manager or disposed of through EHS.

Protect terminals and connectors from short circuiting with nonconductive caps, tape, or covers when not connected for use or charging.

Keep batteries away from loose metal tools, screws, wire offcuts, keys, coins, conductive trays, and other batteries that could bridge terminals.

Do not puncture, crush, bend, drop, disassemble, solder directly to cells, bypass a BMS, or use a pack with damaged insulation or wiring.

Transport batteries inside the lab in a stable nonconductive carrier or padded container. Carry large high-energy packs one at a time where practical.

Allow batteries to return to room temperature before charging if warm from use or cold from storage or transport. Do not charge below freezing or outside manufacturer temperature limits.

Charging Station Requirements

Charging shall occur on the approved charger at the metal charging table under supervision.

Bring only the battery or batteries being actively charged to the charging table. Do not stage extra packs on the table.

The table shall be clear of flammables and unrelated batteries, and sand buckets and tongs shall be accessible.

Do not charge inside the storage cabinet unless an approved charging-container setup has been reviewed for the pack, charger, heat, and venting requirements.

Pre-charge Inspection

Before connecting any battery to a charger, inspect the battery and charger. Do not charge if any fail condition is present.

Do not charge if the battery shows swelling, puffing, deformation, split seams, dents, punctures, cracks, melted case, abrasion exposing cells, liquid, residue, smoke, hissing, unusual odor, or abnormal warmth.

Do not charge if discharge leads, balance leads, connector housings, pins, strain relief, or insulation are damaged, corroded, loose, melted, or expose conductors.

Do not charge if the pack identity, chemistry, cell count, or voltage condition is unknown.

1. Inspect the battery body for physical damage, swelling, leakage, odor, smoke, hissing, or abnormal warmth.

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2. Inspect wiring and connectors for intact insulation, housings, pins, solder joints, and strain relief.
3. Confirm the pack is identified and that chemistry and cell count are known.
4. If cell voltage is unavailable for a no-BMS pack, check it before charging.
5. Confirm the charger is approved for the battery chemistry, cell count, and current.
6. Confirm the area is clear and that sand and tongs are accessible and supervision will be maintained.

Battery body	No swelling, deformation, puncture, cracks, melted case, exposed cells, liquid, residue, smoke, hissing, unusual odor, or abnormal warmth.
Wiring and connectors	Leads, connector housings, pins, strain relief, and insulation are intact with no exposed conductor, corrosion, bent pins, melted plastic, or loose connector.
Cell/pack state	Pack is identified, chemistry and cell count are known, and the pack has not been over-discharged or stored at unknown voltage.
Charger	Approved for the chemistry, cell count, and current; balance connector available for 2S+ no-BMS packs; profile understood before connection.
Area	Table is clear, sand and tongs are accessible, and the user can remain in or near the area for the entire charge session.

Charging Procedure

Use only approved chargers and settings for the specific battery type.

Do not parallel-charge packs unless a written procedure and PI/EHS approval have been obtained.

For series packs of 2S or greater without a BMS, balance-charge with a charger capable of monitoring individual cells.

As a conservative default for non-BMS LiPo packs, do not exceed 1C unless the manufacturer and a PI-approved procedure allow a higher charge rate.

Do not charge overnight or unattended. Stay in or near the lab for the entire charge session.

1. Confirm that you are trained and authorized to charge the battery type.
2. Bring only the battery or batteries being actively charged to the charging table.
3. Complete the pre-charge inspection.
4. If the battery is swollen, damaged, hot, leaking, smoking, or unknown, stop and follow the abnormal battery procedure.
5. Verify charger mode and battery chemistry. Select only the mode that matches the battery documentation.
6. Set cell count, voltage limit, charge current, and balance mode according to the manufacturer.
7. For 2S or greater series packs without a BMS, connect for balance charging.
8. Start charging and remain in or near the lab for the entire charge session.
9. Monitor for abnormal heat, odor, swelling, smoke, charger errors, or other unusual behavior.

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10. When charging is complete, disconnect promptly and move the battery to approved storage or install it in equipment for immediate use.

11. If the battery will not be used for more than 3 days, return it to storage voltage/SOC unless manufacturer instructions specify otherwise.

Storage Requirements

Store batteries only in approved locations assigned for their category.

Do not store batteries on the charging table, regular lab benches, desks, floors, robots, drawers, carts, backpacks, or ordinary cabinets.

Do not store a battery connected to a charger, robot, test fixture, power supply, or loose extension lead.

Keep the yellow cabinet door closed and BAT-SAFE/BatBox lids latched except while placing or removing batteries.

Store high-energy no-BMS packs in a way that prevents leads from crossing or packs from pressing against one another electrically. Use separators, trays, or individual sleeves as needed.

Small 4S/6S LiPo packs	Store in the assigned BAT-SAFE/BatBox.
Large high-energy packs, including large no-BMS soft packs and smart UAV packs	Store in the yellow fire-resistant cabinet.
OEM robot batteries	Store in the yellow fire-resistant cabinet, OEM case, or other OEM/EHS-approved storage.
Damaged/suspect batteries	Do not place in normal storage; use quarantine procedure.

Storage Voltage / State of Charge

Storage voltage reduces stress on Li-ion/LiPo cells and can reduce risk compared with long-term fully charged storage. Manufacturer instructions take priority.

If manufacturer instructions are unavailable, standard LiPo/Li-ion multi-cell packs without BMS should be placed in charger storage mode and targeted to approximately 3.75-3.85 V per cell.

LiHV packs shall use the manufacturer-specified LiHV storage mode. Do not select LiHV charge mode unless the pack is clearly marked as high-voltage/LiHV and the charger is approved for it.

Smart/BMS/OEM packs shall follow OEM storage/SOC instructions and charger prompts. If no OEM value is available, keep packs in a moderate SOC range rather than fully charged for long periods.

For packs not expected to be used for more than 3 days, return to storage voltage/SOC unless manufacturer instructions specify otherwise.

Monthly Battery Manager Inspection

Each participating lab shall assign a Battery Manager to inspect the batteries under that lab's responsibility at least once per calendar month.

Inspections should be completed during the first week of the month where practical.

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Inspection records shall be retained in the shared lab safety folder for at least three years or longer if required by institutional policy.

1. Confirm each battery ID is present or documented as in use, disposed, missing, or transferred.
2. Confirm batteries are in assigned BAT-SAFE/BatBox, yellow cabinet, quarantine, active use, or active charging; remove idle batteries from the charging table.
3. Check visual condition including swelling, cracks, puncture, leaks, odor, heat, corrosion, connector damage, insulation damage, balance lead damage, and label readability.
4. For no-BMS packs, record individual cell voltages and minimum/maximum spread using a balance checker or charger.
5. For BMS/OEM packs, record SOC, status, error indicators, and individual cell data if available.
6. Bring batteries back to storage mode/SOC if outside the lab default or manufacturer range and safe to do so.
7. Label, quarantine, dispose, repair labels/connectors only if authorized, update inventory, and notify owner/lab manager of issues.
8. Verify tongs and sand buckets are present and accessible; report missing or depleted supplies immediately.

Swollen, Damaged, Abnormal, or End-of-Life Batteries

A swollen, punctured, leaking, hot, smoking, hissing, odorous, water-damaged, over-discharged, or physically damaged battery shall not be charged, used, transported casually, or returned to normal storage.

Do not store damaged batteries with normal batteries in a crowded BAT-SAFE/BatBox or cabinet shelf.

Do not attempt to discharge a damaged or swollen battery as a disposal preparation step unless EHS/PI has approved a written method for that battery type.

1. Stop work and keep the battery away from flammables and people.
2. If the battery is hot, smoking, venting, leaking, hissing, or on fire, do not handle it and follow emergency procedures.
3. If the battery is cool, stable, and not leaking or venting, label it DO NOT USE - DAMAGED/SUSPECT.
4. Protect terminals if this can be done safely.
5. Isolate or quarantine the battery if safe to do so.
6. Notify the Battery Manager and arrange EHS hazardous-waste disposal.
7. Do not return the battery to normal storage or charge it.

Emergency Procedures

Lithium battery emergencies may involve rapid heating, fire, cell rupture, projectile fragments, dense smoke, and toxic/corrosive gases. Personal safety takes priority over saving batteries, chargers, robots, or other equipment.

If smoke, flame, popping, hissing, or heat is coming from a BAT-SAFE/BatBox or the yellow cabinet, stay away and keep the lid or door closed. Do not open the container to inspect, rescue, or extinguish the battery.

Users are not expected to fight lithium battery fires. Use extinguishers only if trained, the fire is small or incipient, you have a clear exit, and there is no heavy smoke.

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Sand is acceptable as a local containment or smothering method for a small Li-ion/LiPo pack event when it can be applied safely, but it does not cool the cells or guarantee thermal runaway has stopped.

1. Alert people nearby by clearly stating battery fire or battery smoke.
2. Stop work and move people away from the battery and smoke path.
3. If there is smoke, fire, explosion, or heavy odor, evacuate the room, activate the local alarm if required, and call emergency response.
4. Do not breathe smoke or fumes.
5. If it is safe and can be done without approaching the battery or smoke plume, stop the charger using the charger stop button or AC power switch.
6. Do not disconnect battery leads from a hot, smoking, venting, or burning battery.
7. Keep others out of the area until the battery is cool and EHS or emergency responders clear the area.
8. If a battery incident occurs inside a BAT-SAFE/BatBox or yellow cabinet, do not open the container; evacuate and wait for responders.
9. If leaving a battery on the metal charging table creates a greater immediate hazard, a trained user may as a last resort use the provided metal tongs to move it to a clear noncombustible floor area away from equipment and exits, then cover it with dry sand.
10. After any fire or incident, treat the battery, residue, sand, tongs, and cleanup materials as hazardous waste until cleared by EHS or emergency responders.

Training Requirements

All users shall review this SOP, complete general lab safety or induction, and know storage locations, charging station rules, emergency exits, alarms, tongs, sand buckets, and the reporting chain.

Users charging batteries require hands-on charger training for the specific battery type, including chemistry, cell count, current setup, balance charging, storage mode, inspection, and abnormal battery response.

Battery Managers require training on monthly inspection methods, cell-voltage/SOC measurement, inventory updates, quarantine/disposal, emergency supply checks, and record retention.

Refresher training is required annually, after SOP revision, after an incident or near miss, or before handling a new battery technology.

Troubleshooting

- If battery identity, chemistry, cell count, or charger profile is uncertain, do not charge.
- If the battery is swollen, punctured, leaking, smoking, hot, odorous, corroded, or physically damaged, do not use or charge it; label and quarantine if safe.
- If charger errors occur or individual cell condition is unknown for a no-BMS pack, stop and have the battery evaluated by the Battery Manager.
- If a battery is warm from use or cold from storage/transport, allow it to return to room temperature before charging.
- If a battery is outside storage voltage/SOC range and safe to correct, return it to storage mode/SOC.

Maintenance

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- Each participating lab's Battery Manager shall inspect batteries at least once per calendar month.
- Maintain current inventory, approved storage layout, inspection records, training records, emergency supplies, and signage.
- Verify sand buckets and tongs are present and accessible during monthly inspections.
- Inspection records shall be retained in the shared lab safety folder for at least three years or longer if required by institutional policy.

Appendix A provides a pre-charge checklist for every charge session. For large no-BMS packs, new packs, repaired packs, or batteries returning from long storage, use a written checklist/log.

8. WASTE DISPOSAL

Swollen, damaged, abnormal, unknown, or end-of-life rechargeable lithium batteries shall not be returned to normal storage or casually transported. Label suspect batteries DO NOT USE - DAMAGED/SUSPECT, isolate or quarantine if safe, notify the Battery Manager, and arrange disposal through EHS as hazardous waste. If a damaged battery is placed in a container with sand or other extinguishing media, the container, media, residues, and battery shall be treated as hazardous waste until cleared by EHS. Do not attempt to discharge a damaged or swollen battery as a disposal preparation step unless EHS/PI has approved a written method for that battery type.

9. EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

Health-Threatening Emergencies

- Fire, explosion, health-threatening hazardous material spill or release, compressed gas leak, or valve failure, etc.
- Call 999.
- Alert people in the vicinity and activate the local alarm systems.
- Evacuate the area and go to your Emergency Assembly Point (EAP).
- Remain nearby to advise emergency responders.
- Once personal safety is established, call Public Safety.
- Provide local notifications.

Injuries and Exposures

- Remove the injured or exposed individual from the area unless it is unsafe to do so.
- Call 999 if immediate medical attention is required.
- Report any exposure to EH&S.
- Administer first aid as appropriate.
- Flush contamination from eyes or skin using the nearest emergency eyewash or shower for a minimum of 15 minutes. Remove any contaminated clothing.

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Non-Health-Threatening Emergencies

- For injuries and exposures that are not considered serious or a medical emergency, call Dr. Tehmina Kazmi on 02-628-8102.

Local Cleanup of Small Spills

- Notify personnel in the area and restrict access. Eliminate all sources of ignition.
- Review the SDS for the spilled material and determine the appropriate level of protection.
- Wear appropriate PPE, clean up the spill, and manage cleanup debris as hazardous waste.
- Remove waste items to the waste room.

Lab-Specific Procedures

- Alert people nearby by clearly stating battery fire or battery smoke.
- If there is smoke, fire, explosion, or heavy odor, evacuate the room and keep away from fumes.
- If safe and without approaching the battery or smoke plume, stop the charger using the charger stop button or AC power switch.
- Do not disconnect or move a hot, smoking, venting, or burning battery unless leaving it in place creates a greater immediate hazard and the user is trained to use the provided tools.
- If an incident occurs inside a BAT-SAFE/BatBox or yellow cabinet, do not open the container; keep it closed and wait for emergency responders/EHS.
- As a last resort only, a trained user may use the provided metal tongs to move a battery to a clear noncombustible floor area away from equipment and exits, then cover it with dry sand.
- After any battery fire or venting event, keep the area isolated and treat the battery, residue, sand, tongs, and cleanup materials as hazardous waste until cleared by EHS/emergency responders.

Building Maintenance Emergencies

- Call Facilities Operations for building maintenance emergencies (e.g., power outages, plumbing leaks).
- Laboratory Operations: Tariq Abu Issa - tia1@nyu.edu - 050-5636228
- Facilities Management: Jake Edmondson - je53@nyu.edu - 02-628-4756 / 056-194-5026

Local Notifications

- Responsible Person: Oraib Al-Ketan - oga2@nyu.edu - 02-628-7735
- Laboratory Operations: Tariq Abu Issa - tia1@nyu.edu - 050-5636228

10. TRAINING REQUIREMENTS

General Training (*check all that apply*):

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ General Safety Orientation | ☐ Safety Risk Assessment Training |
| ☒ Laboratory Safety Induction | ☐ Blood borne pathogens |
| ☐ Basic X-Ray Safety Training Course | ☐ Compressed Gases Safety Training |
| ☐ Biosafety Induction Training | |

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NAME	PI	EMAIL ID	DATE	SIGNATURE